



Name: Cohort/Batch: Date: Score:

REDPANDA PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Messaging & Streaming

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What is Redpanda and what problem in Messaging & Streaming does it solve? **Threat Model**

Q6 How does Redpanda handle reliability and high availability? **Reliability**

Q2 What are the core components or concepts in Redpanda? **Architecture**

Q7 What observability does Redpanda provide out of the box? **Recycle**

Q3 How does Redpanda compare to its main alternatives? **Configuration**

Q8 What are common performance bottlenecks in Redpanda? **Compliance**

Q4 How do you get started with Redpanda for a new project? **Hardening**

Q9 What security best practices apply when running Redpanda? **Design**

Q5 What configuration options most affect Redpanda's behavior in production? **Hardening**

Q10 What mistakes do teams commonly make when adopting Redpanda? **Tuning**



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 Redpanda is a tool or platform that

Mitigation

Redpanda is a tool or platform that automates or simplifies a specific concern in the Messaging & Streaming domain, reducing manual effort and operational complexity for engineering teams.

A6 Redpanda provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling

Redpanda provides HA through leader election, replication, or stateless horizontal scaling. Deploy at least two instances across availability zones and configure health checks for automatic failover.

A2 Redpanda has key building blocks that work

Primitives

Redpanda has key building blocks that work together: a configuration layer defines intent, a runtime layer enforces it, and an API or CLI layer allows operators to manage and observe the system.

A7 Redpanda exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces

Redpanda exposes metrics (Prometheus endpoint or built-in dashboard), structured logs, and optionally distributed traces. Define SLOs on the key metrics and alert before users are affected.

A3 Redpanda trades off simplicity against feature richness

Hardening

Redpanda trades off simplicity against feature richness differently than its alternatives. Choose Redpanda when its specific strengths performance, ecosystem, or ease of use align with your team's primary constraints.

A8 Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches

Performance bottlenecks typically stem from misconfigured connection pools, large payload sizes, insufficient worker threads, or missing caches. Profile with built-in diagnostics before optimizing.

A4 Install Redpanda via its package manager or binary release

Gotchas

Install Redpanda via its package manager or binary release. Follow the quickstart to initialize a project, configure the minimal required settings, and run the default command to verify the setup works end-to-end.

A9 Run Redpanda with the principle of least privilege

Assessment

Run Redpanda with the principle of least privilege, enable TLS for all communication, use a secrets manager for credentials, and keep the software patched to the latest stable release.

A5 Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels

Hardening

Production-critical settings typically include concurrency limits, timeout values, retry policies, resource limits, and logging levels. Review the official production hardening guide before deploying.

A10 Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error, using default configurations in production, lacking a runbook for operational issues, and not testing failover scenarios

Common pitfalls include skipping the documentation and learning the API by trial and error, using default configurations in production, lacking a runbook for operational issues, and not testing failover scenarios.